groups as Gessner saw them: live-bearing quadrupeds (mammals); egg-laying quadrupeds (reptiles and amphibians); birds; fish and aquatic animals; and snakes and scorpions. From 1686–1704, the English naturalist John Ray produced the equivalent register for botany with his *History of Plants*. Within little more than 50 years, the classification of living things would be completely transformed by Carl Linnaeus's *Systema Naturae*.